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AUG - 4 2026

CITY OF SAN CARLOS
CITY CLERK'S DEPARTMENT

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers.
Please make sure you are using proper format before submitting to the City Clerk.

Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure _____ for the General Municipal Election to be held on 11/3/2026.

☐ Primary Argument in Favor of ☑ Primary Argument Against

This argument is submitted by (check ONLY ONE):		
☐	**The Governing Body of the City of San Carlos**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Member(s) of the Governing Body of the City of San Carlos**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☑	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signers of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association.	
	Name of Association: Silicon Valley Taxpayers Association (SVTA)	
	Contact Person's Printed Name: Mark W.A. Hinkle	
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]
☐	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Combination of Voters and Associations**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:

Arguments will be emailed to the contact person listed here for review before they are printed in the Sample Ballot & Official Voter Information Pamphlets.

Please complete the reverse side of this form.

Primary Argument Signers Form	Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is the author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.	Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff check once the eligibility of the signer is verified.

1.	Name: Mark W.A. Hinkle	Title: President, Silicon Valley Taxpayers Associ	☐	N/A
Phone: [redacted]		Email: [redacted]		
Address: [redacted]			Pronouns:	
Signatur[redacted]		Date: 8/2/26	He/His: ☑ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
2.	Name: Divya Mehra	Title: Resident of San Carlos	☑	☑
Phone: [redacted]		Email: [redacted]		
Address: [redacted]			Pronouns:	
Signature: [redacted]		Date: 8/2/26	He/His: ☑ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
3.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
4.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
5.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	

Submit a second form (this side only) for alternate signers attached to this form and the argument.

Argument Against Measure __

[start of argument]

Stop this huge tax increase!

Sales tax hikes disproportionately hurt families with fewer resources.

By law, City Hall already receives 1% of every local taxable sale* — whether online, in local stores, or on residents' vehicle purchases.

Inflation means families pay more. Then inflation also "gifts" City Hall with automatic windfalls, through its 1% share of every price increase!

Although proponents downplay this tax increase as just "one-half cent" more, it's a massive 50% boost to City Hall's take, with every purchase!

In May, San Carlos's Administrative Services Director told the Palo Alto Daily Post that San Carlos faces an estimated annual deficit of $500,000 to $1,000,000.

Then why are councilmembers pushing for another $6,000,000 annually for 14 years ($84,000,000 total!)?

Palo Alto Daily Post's article answered that:
Funding projects like Highway 101 bicycle bridge, whose cost ballooned to $112;000,000 **(80% over budget!)**.

Plus, City Hall's June mailer states they've "identified" $200,000,000 in unfunded capital improvement projects.

Although this measure touts essential services, its text admits this tax increase is for "**general** government use."

That's a legal **blank check**! Funds could feed bloated payrolls and councilmembers' pet projects, instead of vital services we'd favor.

Designating Measure __ as a *general* sales tax instead of a *special* tax (or bond measure) is a bait-and-switch allowing City Hall to bypass normal expenditure guardrails and the taxpayer protection of a 2/3 supermajority requirement for such projects. **We're talking $84 million!**

So-called "independent audits" only track spending *after* the fact; they don't prevent waste.

Worse, Measure __ is stacked upon the separate 0.5% regional sales tax measure, threatening to skyrocket San Carlos's rate to 10.375% — all piled on top of another $489/year parcel tax measure!

Ordinary families must stick to their budget — despite inflation.

Force **City Hall to do the same with our tax money.**

Vote NO!

**Bradley-Burns rate*

Visit: SVTaxpayers.org

[end of argument]

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[redacted]

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[end of argument]